

**Board 1**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ T 2  
 ♥ J 9 2  
 ♦ T 8 4 3 2  
 ♣ K Q 3

♠ Q 4  
 ♥ Q T 7  
 ♦ A J 6  
 ♣ A T 9 8 6



♠ A 8 7 3  
 ♥ 6 5  
 ♦ K Q 9  
 ♣ J 7 5 2

♠ K J 9 6 5  
 ♥ A K 8 4 3  
 ♦ 7 5  
 ♣ 4

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              |       |      | 1 ♠   |
| Pass         | 2 ♣   | Pass | 2 ♥   |
| Pass         | 2NT   | Pass | 3 ♥   |
| Pass         | 4 ♥   |      |       |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 4 ♥ by South |       |      |       |

South opens 1 ♠. So far you know you belong in game, but you don't know which game. What do you bid first? You respond 2 ♣, natural and forcing the partnership to game. South now bids his ♥ suit. At this point you figure South for 5 ♠s and 4 ♥s. What should you rebid? You cannot support either of South's Majors, but with a good stopper in the fourth suit you bid 2NT. The game force is still on and South may not pass this bid. South bids 3 ♥, indicating that this is also a 5-card suit. What do you rebid now?

Now you can bid the ♥ game, knowing there is an 8-card fit.

**Board 2**

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q  
 ♥ J 8 4  
 ♦ J T 2  
 ♣ K J T 5 4 3

♠ A J T 7 4

♥ K T 7

♦ A 9 5

♣ 7 2



♠ K 9 8 3 2

♥ 6 2

♦ 8 7 4

♣ A 8 6

♠ 6 5

♥ A Q 9 5 3

♦ K Q 6 3

♣ Q 9

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
| Pass         | 1 ♠   | Pass | 2 ♥   |
| Pass         | 3 ♥   | Pass | 4 ♥   |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 4 ♥ by South |       |      |       |

What do you open with this hand? You opens 1 ♠ and South, responds 2 ♥. Note that this promises a 5-card or longer ♥ suit. (2 of a minor only promises 4+). What do you rebid? Knowing that South has 5, you bid 3 ♥ to confirm the trump suit. South bids 4 ♥.

South went straight to game, showing a minimum opener and no slam interest. You are also satisfied to just play at game.

2/1 is a good bidding method, and here, 4 ♥ is a good contract. But you can see that it is not a laydown - there is no bidding system that will always reach 100% contracts. In this hand a 3-3 ♦ split will provide the 10th trick, or if that fails, taking 2 ♠ finesses provides a 75% chance of success.

**Board 3**

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ J T 8  
 ♥ Q 2  
 ♦ A J 9 5 3  
 ♣ 5 4 3

♠ 7  
 ♥ A K 7 5  
 ♦ K 7 6 2  
 ♣ K Q T 6

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ Q 4 3  
 ♥ J 6 4  
 ♦ Q T 8  
 ♣ J 9 7 2

♠ A K 9 6 5 2  
 ♥ T 9 8 3  
 ♦ 4  
 ♣ A 8

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          |       |      | 1 ♠   |
| Pass     | 2 ♣   | Pass | 2 ♥   |
| Pass     | 3 ♥   | Pass | 4 ♥   |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

4 ♥ by South

more card. South will always have the chance to rebid spades later if there is no heart fit.

South opens 1 ♠.

You have 15 HCP, but you only have 4 ♥s, so you can't bid 2 ♥ (this would promise a 5-card suit). So instead you bid clubs. This is natural and game-forcing, but only promises 4+ clubs. Note that holding two 4-card minors you bid them up-the-line, just as in standard bidding. South rebids 2 ♥. This shows at least 4 hearts. What do you rebid now? Your 3 ♥ bid confirms hearts as trump. There's no worry partner might pass - we are in a game forcing auction. South raises to 4 ♥, showing no slam interest.

We don't have enough for slam opposite a minimum opener, so we just pass. Note South's decision to show the poor 4-card heart suit for their second bid, instead of showing the 6th spade. In a GF sequence, it's more important to tell about 4 more cards than 1

**Board 4**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 4 3  
 ♥ 7 6 2  
 ♦ K 6 3  
 ♣ A T 4 3 2

♠ A K 9 2  
 ♥ A Q 9 8 3  
 ♦ 8 5  
 ♣ 8 6



♠ Q J T 6  
 ♥ J T 5  
 ♦ 9 4 2  
 ♣ Q J 5

♠ 8 7 5  
 ♥ K 4  
 ♦ A Q J T 7  
 ♣ K 9 7

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              | 1♥    | Pass | 2♦    |
| Pass         | 2♠    | Pass | 2NT   |
| Pass         | 3NT   |      |       |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 3NT by South |       |      |       |

North opens 1♥ - how do you respond? North next bids 2♠, showing the other Major suit. In standard bidding this is a Reverse, showing a strong hand with 5♥s and 4♠s. But after a 2/1 GF response, North doesn't need extra values to show their 4-card spade suit. What should you rebid? You assume North to be 4-5 in the Majors, and since you can't support either one, you bid 2NT. If North actually has 6♥s (or 5♠s) he would rebid the suit. Your 2NT bid guarantees a stopper in the fourth suit.

North does not have either 6♥s or 5♠s so he just bids 3NT. Notice that North never once considered the possibility of passing what might be a misfit - the initial 2/1 response unconditionally forced the partnership to reach a game somewhere.